

power users. It houses the modest Qualcomm Snapdragon 7s Gen 2 processor; meanwhile competitors like the OnePlus Nord CE4 and Nothing Phone (2a) house more powerful processors. The phone has 8/12 GB RAM and 128/256 GB internal storage, and there's no expandable memory support. Multitasking is smooth for the most part, but it can struggle from time to time when more than 15 apps are open. Additionally, the camera app can get particularly laggy at times.

In synthetic benchmarks, the Motorola Edge 50 Fusion lags behind most of its competitors. The OnePlus Nord CE4, Realme Narzo 70 Pro, and Nothing Phone (2a) raced ahead in the AnTuTu benchmark. In GeekBench, the phone was beaten by the OnePlus Nord CE4 convincingly in both tests, but it got a better score than the Nothing Phone (2a) in the Multi-Core test and the Realme Narzo 70 Pro in both Single and Multi-Core tests.

Furthermore, it also beat all its competitors in the PCMark Work benchmarks, which shows its prowess at productivity tasks. The phone also performed admirably well in the CPU Throttling Test, throttling to merely 92 per cent of its peak performance, so its stability is uncompromised even during intensive tasks.

Sadly, it considerably lags behind the OnePlus Nord CE4 and Nothing Phone (2a) in GPU benchmarks such as 3D Mark and GFXBench. In real-world gaming, the phone can easily handle intensive games such as Call of Duty: Mobile and BGMI on Low to Medium graphics, but push it any further and you will face a fair amount of stutters. You also cannot reliably play games such as Genshin Impact as the amount of lag can disrupt your gameplay experience.

So, naturally, this is not the ideal device for hardcore mobile gamers and power users, but for general users, the day-to-day experience is pretty smooth. Hello UI is also one of the cleanest Android skins on the market currently, making the experience more seamless and enjoyable. There are no third-party bloatware apps, which is a rarity in the mid-range Android phone landscape. Additionally, the company has promised three major Android updates

and four years of security updates, which is a step in the right direction.

CAMERA

The Motorola Edge 50 Fusion features an impressive camera setup, led by a 50 MP Sony Lytia 700C primary camera with OIS support. This is complemented by a 13 MP ultrawide camera with Auto Focus, which doubles as a macro lens—a feature Motorola has been championing, and one that other smartphone manufacturers should consider emulating. For selfies and video calls, the phone offers a capable 32 MP front camera.

Photos taken with the primary camera in ideal lighting conditions are vibrant and ready for social media. The images have high contrast and are significantly sharpened, which, while not the most natural look, can be appealing to those who prefer photos requiring minimal to no editing. The dynamic range is decent, capturing sufficient detail in both highlights and shadows. Portrait shots are particularly noteworthy, with excellent edge detection and decent colour accuracy.

The 13 MP ultrawide camera maintains the high-contrast aesthetic but tends to produce slightly grungier photos due to less detail in shadow areas, resulting in a darker overall look. However, the macro mode stands out as one of the best in this price range, thanks to the ultrawide lens' autofocus capabilities.

The 32 MP selfie camera is one of the best in its segment, delivering crisp and detailed shots in both daylight and low light. It excels in colour accuracy and dynamic range, making it a reliable choice for all your selfie needs.

BATTERY LIFE

The Motorola Edge 50 Fusion draws power from 5,000 mAh cell. The phone supports speedy 68 W TurboPower fast charging which tops the phone up from 0-100 percent in just 57 minutes, according to my tests. The battery life, while not the best on the block, is serviceable for most. The phone gave me a good 5-6 hours of screen-on time, which is capable of getting a majority of users through a whole day. Power users may need to top it up in the

evenings though. In our 4K video loop test on VLC, the phone ran for 13 hours and 31 minutes, which is pretty decent battery endurance. Playing games such as COD: Mobile for 15 minutes drains the battery by 5 per cent. All in all, if you're looking for a mid-range phone with the absolute best battery life, this is not the phone for you. However, if you're a casual user, the battery life of the Motorola Edge 50 Fusion is decent enough.

VERDICT

Thanks to its fruitful partnership with Pantone, Motorola has become a master of design over the past few years in the smartphone industry. The Motorola Edge 50 Fusion is a standout device under ₹25,000, offering a luxurious design, decent performance, and impressive camera capabilities. However, its 144 Hz display, while bright and fluid, lacks HDR support, which might disappoint content enthusiasts. The Snapdragon 7s Gen 2 processor handles daily tasks well but falls short in gaming compared to competitors like the OnePlus Nord CE4 and Nothing Phone (2a). The camera setup is a highlight, particularly the 50 MP primary and 32 MP selfie cameras, which deliver vibrant and sharp images. Battery life is serviceable with a 5,000 mAh cell and 68 W fast charging, though power users may need to recharge by evening. Overall, the Edge 50 Fusion excels in design and camera performance, making it a compelling choice for those who prioritize aesthetics and photography, but it faces stiff competition in performance and display quality from rivals in its price range.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Qualcomm Snapdragon 7s Gen 2 | GPU: Adreno 710 | RAM: 8/12 GB | Storage: 128/256 GB | OS: Android 14, Hello UI | Battery: 5,000 mAh | Charging: 68 W TurboPower | Display: 6.67" Full HD+ pOLED, 144 Hz, 1600 nits peak | Cameras (rear): 50 MP Sony Lytia 700C + 13 MP ultrawide | Selfie camera: 32 MP | IP rating: IP68 | Colours: Forest Blue, Marshmallow Blue, Hot Pink

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